



Continuous
Key-Signing
Party
introduction

Gunnar Wolf

Keysigning:
What and
why?

Keysigning:
How?

Our magic
number is...

Keysigning:
Other
stuff...

Continuous Key-Signing Party introduction

https://people.debian.org/~gwolf/dc26_ksp

Gunnar Wolf

DebConf 26 • Santa Fe, Argentina • 2026.07.20



Global project. Powerful people. *Many many people trust us!*

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- Would you trust **me** with...
 - Your house's keys?
 - Your car's keys?
 - Your wallet?
 - Your music collection?
 - Your family photos?
 - Your e-mail / IM history?





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■ Would you trust **me** with...

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■ Do you use Debian?

- ... If so, you **do** trust me more than you know!
- Well, not only me — You trust a group of ≈ 1200 weird volunteers throughout the world

I have the power!

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As a Debian Developer, I can...



- Upload arbitrary packages to the Debian archive
 - Modify whatever binaries you run to my liking
- Have them run code **as root** as part of their preinst, postinst, prerm or postrm, if I want to hide my intentions or ensure my code is run at the appropriate times
- My power in your computers is limitless

Of course, I am a nice guy

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If you get to know me, you *will* trust me!

- I am *honestly* a nice guy!
- Ask anybody in this room... Can you trust Gunnar?
 - Great! Now we are talking!



You only have to repeat this exercise 1200 times... And some of the developers might not have the incredibly good luck to come to your country.

Isn't there a better way?

But there are so many people on the Internet...

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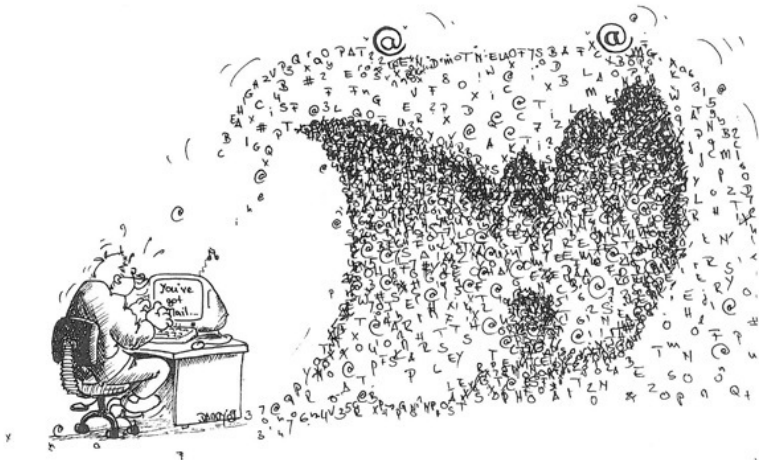
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Bob Doyle (CC BY)



Transitive trust distribution mechanisms

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... But we can trust
somebody, right?

and we can trust on the *truth* of the identities
they are willing to back...

① Centralized trust

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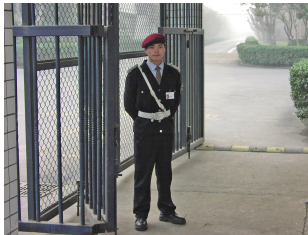
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Robbie Sproule, Wikipedia (CC BY)
Francis Sarahi Castro Ponce, Wikipedia (CC 0)



② Distributed trust

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Miren Pardo, Juegos de asamblea: Conocemos a nuestros compañeros (CC BY-SA-NC)

Transitive trust distribution models

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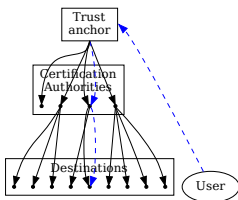
Gunnar Wolf

Keysigning:
What and
why?

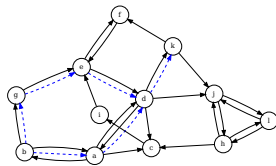
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Centralized: Certification
Authorities (PKI-CA)



Distributed: Web of
Trust (WoT)



Now, it's time to weave the Web of Trust!

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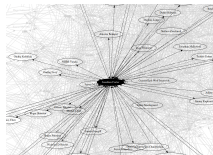
- We can trust the project because we can trust each other('s identity)
- Whenever you meet Free Software people, you can *cross-sign identities* with them
- ... Not every project uses this... But Debian does!



I might be little
connected...



Somewhat more
connected...



I can be *strongly*
connected...

- Having one DD key signature enables you to start the DD process



Short talk, not tutorial

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For this talk, I'm assuming

- You already created your OpenPGP key pair
- You took note of its fingerprint

Not the case? Approach me (or other DDs) later, we will hand-hold you!



caff: Certificate Authority Fire and Forget

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- Package signing-party in Debian: Many tools to help coordinate keysigning
- caff: The preferred way to conduct keysigning!
 - Fetches the requested public key certificates from the keyservers
 - Drives gnupg for signing in your computer
 - Mails the signatures (certificates) to the key owners
 - Just... Fire and forget! (and check... Always check!)



So lets read this from your printed notes!

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- I blogged and mailed `debconf-discuss@lists.debian.org` with the results of the *Key Signing Party* data's checksum (from the file found at https://people.debian.org/~gwolf/dc26_ksp/dc26_fprs.txt)
- Time to verify it. Do you have your printout? We shall read it out loud together *and verify it matches!*
0337 D922 5E6D 44EE 1302 5685 CD53 93B0
D673 E5B2 5E95 5984 27F9 7922 E340 189C



Where are you

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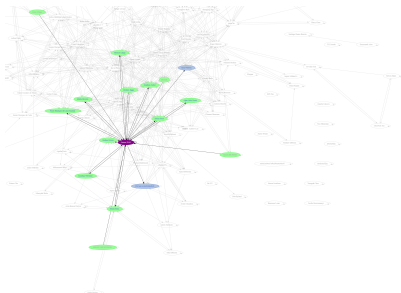
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Gunnar Wolf: 17 related keys (signed by←14 9%, signs→13 8%)
Total keys in KSP: 145. Blue: Signed BY you. Green: Signed TO you. Purple: You.

Are you are in the official
DC26 KSP list?
Find your personal map:

https://people.debian.org/~gwolf/dc26_ksp/

For people not in the official list

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- Can be *any slip of paper* with your full identifying name *and the full fingerprint*
- Hand them over to you



What should I check?

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- Some people will sign upon cross-validating government-issued IDs
- Some people will sign based on *long-time familiarity*
- Every person can (and *should!*) have their own signing policy
 - Somebody denied to sign you? Don't take it personal!
- Just make sure you are *reasonably convinced* of that person's identity
 - Don't lend *Jia Tan*¹ an easy way into our project!

¹Remember the recent xz attack?



Whom should I sign?

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There are really no guidelines to this. But...

- Is *Foo* your friend, and you haven't cross-signed? Go ahead and get yourself signed!
- Is *Bar* many hops away from you? Cross-sign and you will bring more coherence to our strong set!
- Is *Quux* isolated or weakly connected? Bring them in by cross-signing!
- Of course... Are you very weakly connected or disconnected? Don't be shy; cross-sign with as many people as you can.

There is no need to be at the geographic center, only to introduce as much redundancy (in the good sense) as possible.



Now... Go and tighten up our keyring!
Thanks!

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– Gunnar Wolf <gwolf@debian.org>

4D14 0506 53A4 02D7 3687 049D 2404 C954 6E14 5360